

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity.
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It's a hassle to go to a cyber café!

Don't you people like hard rock, death metal, etc.? If yes, why is there no such music on the DVDs so far??

You can include PDF books on the DVD each month—for IT, programming, hardware, or literature. This is a computer technology magazine, no?

The number of pages is constantly decreasing. Every time an anniversary issue is published, the next month's issue's pages are decreased.

P.S.: Why are these guys making such an issue of the July cover? I've never heard anyone saying anything about the pictures in *Tabloid Tech*. (Chuckle, chuckle... after all, those photos are inside, and dad won't see them!)

Vijay Malkoti

You've written a long letter, Vijay—thanks for the effort! But then, space doesn't permit a discussion of all your suggestions. Anyway, here goes.

We did try themed issues, and they weren't much of a success over regular issues. Second, we will in all probability start publishing recommended system configurations for the games we review. But still, we mention our configuration so readers can gauge what kind of experience they will have. Also, a game review is hardly complete without system specs, because the results vary wildly across configurations.

About your DVD getting scratched—I can only say two things: try and keep the disc scratch-free using a soft cloth and by handling it properly, and ask more of your friends to get themselves copies of *Digit*!

I personally don't like death metal, but as far as my readers are concerned, we're a technology magazine... then, about PDFs: most good ones on IT and programming and such are not free, so we can't put them on our discs. Trial keys for software are not possible because you're legally bound to register at the respective site for each license key. Finally, as for the number of pages decreasing, we once made a decision to reduce the number of pages so as to keep the price constant—the page count has not reduced since.

We might make the *Tabloid Tech* page perforated at the side so you can tear it out—and that'll serve two purposes! Just kidding... But I genuinely hope we'll continue to be different, to satisfy the needs of our readers.

— Executive Editor

The Cover Issue

After checking the July cover once again I'm writing to you. But this is actually in reference to Prasanna's reply to my

August letter. He has gauged my intentions exactly the way I wrote it. I'd like to mention here that I was slightly disappointed that you saw my letter with sarcasm. Under no circumstances would I write a sarcastic letter to *Digit*. It's been my beacon of light since many years, and just last month I renewed my subscription for two more years.

Even though I'm not from an IT background, my IT friends still ask me for technology advice: what's the latest PC configuration, when is the iPhone coming to India, etc. I quickly check *Digit* issues and get back to them. Clever, eh?

To further prove my point, I'm requesting the design team to keep publishing such covers from time to time. Prasanna, I've scanned that cover...

Navin D'Cunha

Dear Navin,
I look at this as a healthy debate—and I'm also happy other readers are participating! You see, there was *one* cue that made me think your letter was sarcastic—you said something along the lines of your looking back at the cover to see what the model was holding. In any case, I'm now clear about what you meant—and I hadn't held anything against you in the first place.

Thanks for your continued patronage, and here's hoping you like the covers to come!

— Executive Editor

Coming Clean

After reading about piracy and your Linux issue, I removed my Windows XP, which wasn't legal, and installed Ubuntu 7.04 which you provided with your DVD. Then I updated it and installed software. It gives me satisfaction that now I'm not a thief.

However, now, the software on the discs is of no use to me because I have no *Digit* archive for Linux. *Digit*, who supports Linux so strongly, do not have an archive for Linux—not even for Ubuntu! What a shame...

**Praveen Agrawal
Jaipur**

We do not yet have an archive for Linux, Praveen. It takes time, money, and effort. We take our readers' letters seriously, but, like everyone else, we have our resource limitations. We'll do our best, however.

— Executive Editor

Go Open, India!

I'm in the final days of my RHCE certification course. One thing I've learnt in this course is that Linux truly is a rock-solid OS. It's really fun to use the command line interface!

I recently found on Wikipedia that Linux and open source products are taking a big leap in European nations. The EU and the French Parliament were among the first to adapt Linux as their operating system. They also discarded MS Office and started using OpenOffice.org... there are more examples.

I've learnt that our former president Dr Kalam is an ardent follower of open source. The Supreme Court also utilises Linux and OpenOffice.org for its daily tasks. One question comes to mind: if the governments of developed nations can promote open source software, why can't our Government do it? I'm not against Microsoft, but I'm against their pricing. All official work in Indian offices require MS Office—even clerks use Office! If the Government decided to implement OpenOffice.org (if not Linux) in offices, it would save us millions of rupees. It would also save us a lot of bandwidth in terms of updates.

Then, on the Linux front, there are no viruses, adware, spyware. LIC runs on Red Hat. Some Latin American countries are leading adopters of open source. These countries are also developing countries...

Here in Asia, too, we have many examples. Iran is under sanctions from the US Government. No US-made product can be exported to Iran. They can't even download Java from Sun's site because of sanctions. It seems that they would fall off into the Dark Ages, but they use Linux. China has adopted the open source processor, OpenSparc. Some Indian states like Kerala and Tamil Nadu have migrated their systems to Linux.

Once the use of OSS grows, so will support. Our government should seriously take measures regarding this.

**Tarun Brari
Mandi, H.P.**

Dear Tarun

This is the fourth time you're writing in, I believe—I'm glad. I just hope someone in the Government reads what you've spelt out.

On my part, all I can add is that I wish the Government would take note of spiralling piracy and its effects.

— Executive Editor

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH